SUPPORT AND FAQS

1. What is Simhasth 2028: Grand Innovation Challenge?

The Ujjain Simhastha Kumbh Mela 2028 is expected to be one of the largest human gatherings in the world, bringing together pilgrims, tourists, sadhus, residents, service providers, volunteers, security personnel, and transport operators, across a large and dynamically changing urban environment. The scale, duration, geographic spread, and temporary nature of the event create a complex set of operational challenges. Conventional infrastructure and manually coordinated systems may not be sufficient to anticipate demand, manage real-time movement, maintain cleanliness, and ensure uninterrupted availability of essential goods and services.

The Grand Innovation Challenge is an initiative that seeks multi-disciplinary solutions rooted in technology and human centered design that are scalable, interoperable and field-deployable and can support authorities in proactive preparation for the large human-scale gathering.

The challenge is organised under four interconnected problem areas.

- Mobility and Traffic Management
- Crowd Management and Pilgrim Safety
- Sanitation and Cleanliness Management
- Supply Chain and logistics management

2. What are the timelines of the Grand Innovation Challenge?

The Grand Innovation Challenge will run for a duration of 12 months during which winning applications are expected to curate solutions to meet local requirements. The phases of the Challenge are explained below:

- Challenge Launch | October 2026: The Grand Innovation Challenge will officially launch on the 28th of October at the Urban Conclave in Indore. With the launch, the Challenge will be open to applications.
- Submission of proposals | till December 28th 2026: Enterprises and academic institutions from across the world are encouraged to apply. Interested applicants will have eight weeks from the launch to submit proposals on one or more themes.
- Announcement of winning entries | February 2027: Proposals will be evaluated by an expert panel of judges and winning entries will be announced in February of 2027.
- Solution development and pilot deployment | February to September 2027: Winning entries will have eight months to curate solutions for the Simhasth and deploy pilots in a pre-defined precinct area.
- Deployment at scale and institutional integration: October 2027 onwards: Applications with potential for real impact and scalability will be asked to work with the administration to deploy solutions at scale.

3. **Who can apply for the Grand Innovation Challenge?**
    - Legally registered organisations or academic institutions can apply for the Grand Innovation Challenge.
    - Partnerships between two or more entities can submit proposals
    - Global organisations can submit proposals provided they have an India partner

For more information, please refer to the eligibility criteria.

4. **Can I submit an application for more than one theme?**

Yes. Interested enterprises or academic institutions can submit proposals for more than one theme. However, applications must be submitted as individual proposals. While applicants are encouraged to demonstrate cross cutting capabilities across themes, proposals must be anchored in one theme.

5. **Do winning applicants retain the intellectual property rights of their solutions?**

Winning applicants will retain the intellectual property rights of their solutions developed and deployed for the Grand Innovation Challenge. Selected applicants must be willing to share information about their solutions for the purpose of the Challenge. The Challenge team will periodically publish information, insights and impact of solutions on different forms of media. This will not divulge any confidential intellectual property.

6. **What if I have more questions?**

Two information webinars will be conducted for more information on the Challenge. Interested participants can attend these webinars for any clarification. Announcements of these webinars will be posted on the website of the Grand Innovation Challenge. Additionally, applicants can write to *rahultiwari@manit.ac.in* with their queries. Please note responses will be prioritized based on relevance and criticality of questions.